MiSTer Custom Frontend

Your own menu for the MiSTer FPGA – with achievements, statistics and a few secrets to find.

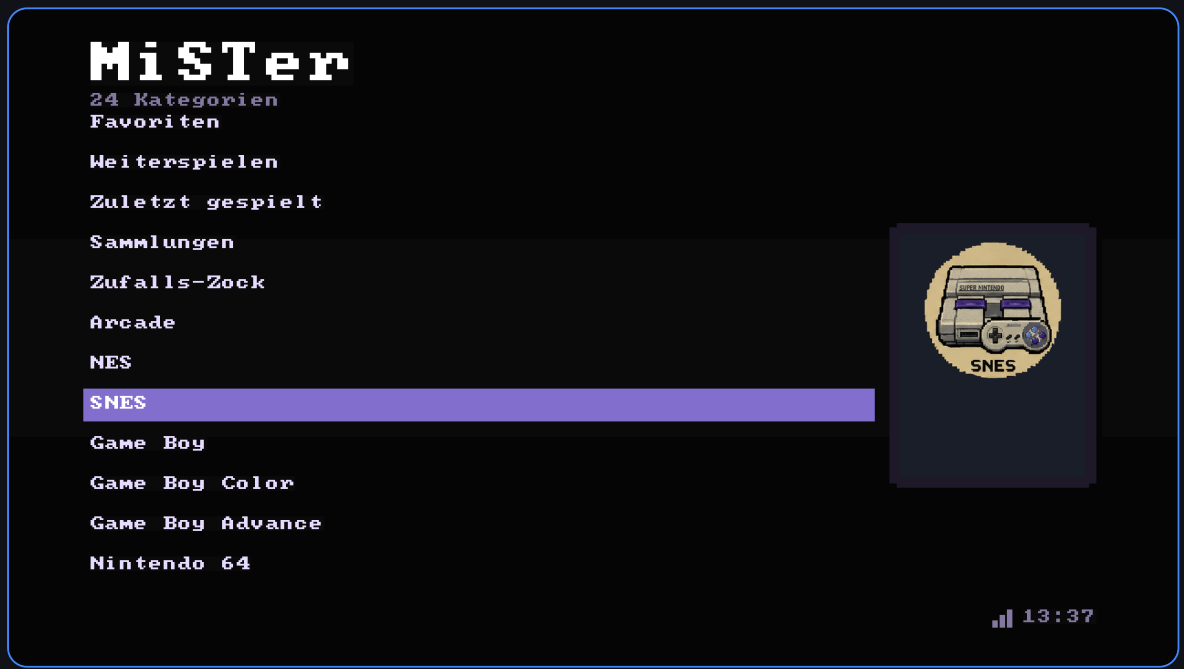
RA — RetroAchievements

★ — Trophy Room

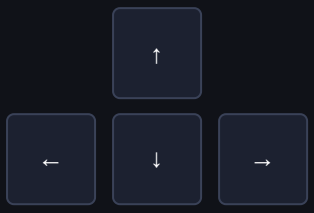
▦ — Collections

? — Secrets

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE



KEYBOARD



Move

OK / ENTER

Select, enter a folder

ESC

Back / quit dialogue

The function key row (along the top of any keyboard):

F3	F4	F6	F7	F8	F10	F11	F12
List start	List end	RA showcase	Completed	Favourite	Switch view	Random game	MiSTerOSD

Also:

F1 (in a game)	Straight back to the frontend – no holding
ESC (hold)	Same as F1, but hold it for about 0.6 s – needed because many games use ESC themselves
F2 or /	Start the search (matches anywhere in the name) – both keys do the same thing
F5 (tap, in the menu)	Next music track – same as a “next track” media key, if your keyboard has one *While a game is running the same key (held) resets the core instead - see below.*
F5 (in a game)	Reset the running core (all cores, RA included) – no holding *It fires immediately. Try it in a game you do not mind losing first.*

Every key can be remapped under System → Input & Language.
(Except the search and the secret codes – those are wired in on purpose.)

GAMEPAD

(Example mapping – applies to any standard USB pad)

D-Pad / Stick	Move – one step at a time, like the arrow keys.	A	Select, enter a folder – same as OK/ENTER.
B	Back / quit dialogue – same as ESC.	X	From the MiSTer OSD back to the frontend.
Y	Next music track – same as F5 on the keyboard.	Start	Select, enter a folder – equivalent to A.
Select	Back / quit dialogue – like B/ESC. Three times in a row confirms the quit straight away.	Guide / Mode	Open the MiSTer OSD – same as F12.
L / R	Page through the list – like left/right.	L2 / R2	Toggle favourite (games only) – same as F8.

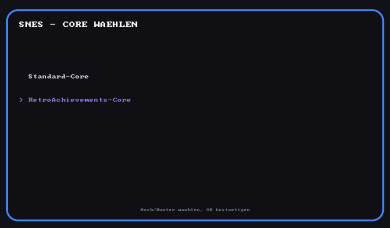
Pad missing a button (no L2/R2, say)? Every action can be moved onto a button you do have, under System → Input & Language → Configure buttons.

FEATURES



STATISTICS

Trophy room, year in review and play diary: playtime, favourite system and progress at a glance.



RETROACHIEVEMENTS

Entering a system that supports RA, you pick: the standard core, or the RA core with real achievements.



ACHIEVEMENTS

F6 shows a game's full achievement list – unlocked or still open, right there in the menu.



FAVOURITES

Games you mark with F8 collect in their own category – always within reach.



RANDOM PICK

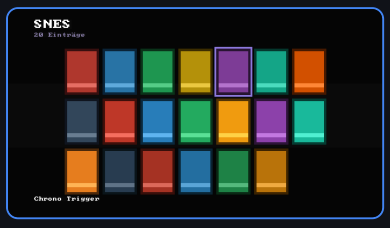
Cannot decide? Three random games at once – and no repeats until every game has had its turn.



SEARCH

Jump straight to a game with / or F2 – matching anywhere in the name, not just the start.

VIEWS & COVER ART



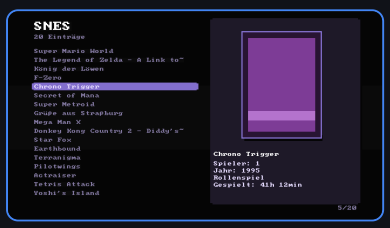
FOUR + SIX VIEWS – KEY F10

Game list: list, grid, gallery and **coverflow**. Main page: the same three plus **tile wall**, **dashboard** and **carousel**. Both set separately; F10 cycles through them, the menu remembers your default. The new views need an HDMI picture – on a CRT the key skips them.



GAME DESCRIPTIONS

In gallery view a description of the game sits next to the cover. It comes from the artwork database on the card – nothing to set up.



GETTING COVER ART

System → Maintenance → “Download box art” fetches it on the MiSTer itself. If you use **Update All**, it is often already under /media/fat/docs – the frontend reads that by itself. Not required, just convenient.



SINGLE-GAME FOLDERS

On PSX, Mega CD and Saturn each game usually sits in its own folder, because one .cue brings several .bin files with it. Those folders are dissolved – the game appears directly in the list, with cover art, grid and gallery. Multi-disc games stay folders. Can be turned off under System → Options.



PREPARING THUMBNAILS

Cover art sits on the card at full size and has to be scaled down the first time you look at it – a short wait per game. This does it in advance, once, and stores the result on the card. After that every cover is there instantly, even after a reboot. You can stop and continue later at any time.